revolutionaries find themselves at the moment of *beginning*, a new state in history'.[6] The reason for this is that 'the precedent set by Lenin and his professional revolutionaries is enabling: the Bolshevik stands as the signal of a "New Age" and an emergent world-historical moment'.[7] One reason for this was that,

> Bhagat Singh lived in a decade and in a country where he knew mobilization was possible; Gandhi had demonstrated that much. This precedent, buttressed by assumptions about the inexorability of class war; the example of worker strikes in 1928 Bombay, Calcutta and Madras; and evidence of the state's anxiety to curtail labour mobilisation converge to impress a historical moment which cannot be denied.[8]

Moffat's estimation of the HSRA is that 'they fight for the present and all its possibility: as a volcano on the brink, seething toward a future not yet determined but one which will demand equally that revolutionary spirit'.[9] In fact, he could hardly have put it any better when he insightfully observes that ultimately, 'Bhagat Singh is constituted in popular opinion as *the subject of a discourse of truth*: courageous in his conviction, responsive to singularity, rejecting mysticism and blind faith'.[10] Yet, the question may be asked: what was this 'fight for the present'? And what was this 'possibility' that Moffat was alluding to? They were extraordinarily wide-ranging, extending from free education to an end to war based on 'imperialist designs'; from the rehabilitation of criminals to the replacement of the League of Nations with a world federation and from universal suffrage to a democratic unicameral legislature and the removal of state governors. Not Gandhi, and not anyone else in India's leadership at the time, was advocating such a root and branch reform. And yet, here was a twenty-three-year-old former student doing just that.

When Lala Ram Saran Das, who was sentenced after the first Lahore Conspiracy Case in 1915 to life imprisonment, asked Bhagat Singh to write an introduction to his *The Dreamland*, it gave Bhagat Singh the opportunity to expound upon the nature of society that Bhagat Singh wished to create after his socialist revolution. Saran Das had written the book while detained in Salem Central Prison in the Madras Presidency. After his release from